

1. Introduction

The **AICTE Pragati Scholarship Scheme** is a flagship scholarship program introduced by the Government of India to encourage and support girl students pursuing technical education. The scheme aims to promote women's empowerment through education by providing financial assistance to deserving female students studying in AICTE-approved institutions.

The scholarship helps students meet educational expenses such as tuition fees, books, stationery, computers, software, and other academic requirements. The scheme is implemented by AICTE under the Ministry of Education, Government of India.

2. Objective of the Scheme

The major objectives of the Pragati Scholarship Scheme are:

- 1. To encourage girls to pursue higher technical education.
 - 2. To increase female participation in engineering, technology, and diploma courses.
 - 3. To reduce financial barriers faced by economically weaker families.
 - 4. To promote gender equality in technical education.
 - 5. To empower women with knowledge, skills, and confidence.
 - 6. To improve employment opportunities for female students.
 - 7. To support the Government's vision of women empowerment through education.
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3. Key Features of the Scheme

Feature	Details
Scheme Name	AICTE Pragati Scholarship
Beneficiary	Girl Students
Implementing Agency	AICTE
Scholarship Amount	₹50,000 per year
Income Limit	Up to ₹8 Lakh per annum
Course Type	Technical Diploma and Degree Courses
Application Mode	Online
Scholarship Mode	Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT)
Maximum Beneficiaries	Limited seats every year
Renewal Available	Yes

4. Eligibility Criteria

A student must satisfy the following conditions:

Gender Requirement

- Applicant must be a female student.

Nationality

- Applicant must be an Indian citizen.

Educational Qualification

- Must be admitted to:
 - First Year Degree Course OR
 - First Year Diploma Course OR
 - Second Year through Lateral Entry

Institution Requirement

- Admission must be in an AICTE-approved institution.

Admission Process

- Admission should be through Centralized Admission Process conducted by State Government or Central Government.
- Management quota admissions are generally not eligible.

Family Income

- Annual family income should not exceed ₹8,00,000.

Family Condition

- Maximum two girl children from one family can avail the scholarship.

Scholarship Restriction

- Student should not be receiving another scholarship for the same course from Central or State Government.

5. Benefits of the Scholarship

Under the Pragati Scholarship Scheme, eligible students receive:

Financial Assistance

Scholarship Amount

₹50,000 per annum

The amount can be utilized for:

- Tuition Fees
- Examination Fees
- Books
- Stationery
- Laptop Purchase
- Computer Accessories
- Software
- Laboratory Equipment
- Educational Materials

No separate bills are generally required for these expenses.

6. Duration of Scholarship

Admission Type	Duration
First Year Degree Admission	Entire Course Duration
First Year Diploma Admission	Up to 3 Years
Lateral Entry Students	Up to 2 Years

The scholarship is renewed every year based on satisfactory academic performance.

7. Reservation Policy

Reservations are provided according to Government of India norms:

Category Reservation

SC	15%
ST	7.5%
OBC	27%

General Remaining Seats

Unfilled reserved seats may be transferred to General Category candidates.

8. Documents Required

Applicants need the following documents:

1. Aadhaar Card

2. Passport Size Photograph
3. Income Certificate
4. Admission Letter
5. Bonafide Certificate
6. Fee Receipt
7. Mark Sheets
8. Bank Passbook
9. Caste Certificate (if applicable)
10. Domicile Certificate (if required)
11. Category Certificate
12. Lateral Entry Certificate (if applicable)

All documents should be uploaded in the prescribed format during online application.

9. Application Process

Step 1

Visit the scholarship portal.

Step 2

Register using:

- Aadhaar Number
- Mobile Number
- Email ID

Step 3

Create Login Credentials.

Step 4

Fill Personal Details:

- Name
- Date of Birth
- Address
- Category
- Income Details

Step 5

Fill Academic Details:

- Institution Name
- Course
- Admission Year
- Roll Number

Step 6

Upload Required Documents.

Step 7

Verify all information.

Step 8

Submit Application.

Step 9

Take printout of submitted application.

Step 10

Track application status regularly through the portal.

10. Selection Process

Selection is based on:

1. Eligibility Verification
2. Merit in Qualifying Examination
3. Family Income Criteria
4. Availability of Scholarship Slots
5. Document Verification
6. Institution Verification

Final approval is granted by AICTE after successful verification.

11. Scholarship Disbursement

The scholarship amount is transferred directly to the student's bank account through:

DBT (Direct Benefit Transfer)

PFMS (Public Financial Management System)

Requirements:

- Aadhaar Linked Bank Account
- Active DBT Enabled Account
- Correct Bank Details

Students should regularly check scholarship status on the portal.

12. Renewal Process

To continue receiving the scholarship:

1. Student must pass the previous academic year.
2. Maintain satisfactory academic performance.
3. Submit renewal application online.
4. Upload latest mark sheets.
5. Get institution verification completed.

Failure in examination may lead to cancellation of scholarship benefits.

13. Reasons for Rejection

Applications may be rejected due to:

- Incorrect information
 - Incomplete application
 - Missing documents
 - Income above ₹8 lakh
 - Admission in non-AICTE approved institution
 - Duplicate scholarship claim
 - Invalid bank account details
 - Aadhaar mismatch
 - Failure in verification process
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14. Advantages of the Scheme

Educational Benefits

- Supports higher technical education.
- Reduces financial burden on families.
- Encourages women in STEM fields.

Economic Benefits

- Direct financial assistance.
- Helps purchase educational resources.

Social Benefits

- Promotes gender equality.
- Encourages female empowerment.
- Improves literacy and employment opportunities.

Career Benefits

- Supports professional skill development.
 - Increases employability.
 - Encourages participation in technical industries.
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15. Challenges Faced by Applicants

1. Documentation errors.
2. Aadhaar-bank linking issues.
3. Portal technical problems.
4. Verification delays.
5. Incomplete institution approval process.
6. Incorrect income certificate submission.

Students should ensure accurate information and timely application submission. Community discussions also frequently mention Aadhaar seeding and verification delays as common issues.

16. Impact of the Scheme

The Pragati Scholarship Scheme has significantly contributed to:

- Increasing enrollment of girl students in technical education.
- Reducing dropout rates.
- Supporting economically weaker families.
- Enhancing women's participation in engineering and technology sectors.
- Promoting inclusive education across India.

Thousands of female students benefit from the scheme annually, helping them pursue technical degrees and diploma programs without major financial constraints.

17. Conclusion

The AICTE Pragati Scholarship Scheme is an important initiative of the Government of India aimed at empowering girls through technical education. By providing financial assistance of ₹50,000 per year, the scheme enables deserving female students to pursue diploma and degree programs in AICTE-approved institutions. It promotes educational equality, women's empowerment, and skill development while supporting the nation's objective of increasing female participation in technical and professional education.

Quick Summary

- **Scheme:** AICTE Pragati Scholarship
- **Beneficiaries:** Girl Students
- **Scholarship Amount:** ₹50,000 per year
- **Income Limit:** ₹8 Lakh per annum
- **Courses Covered:** Diploma & Degree Technical Courses
- **Application Mode:** Online
- **Transfer Method:** DBT/PFMS
- **Implementing Agency:** AICTE
- **Maximum Girls per Family:** Two
- **Renewal:** Available based on academic performance